

Autobiographical Sketch

Born and completed Normal School in Michigan where I taught two years before coming to New Mexico.

Worked four years 1920-24 in the mining camps at Hurley where I taught Spanish-speaking children in segregated schools through the fourth grade.

Went to Las Cruces where I taught Anglo-American children (privileged residential section of the city) for four years. Within the city were two segregated elementary schools (6th grade). Here it was possible to ascertain the attitudes and ignorance of the Anglo children who did not meet the Spanish-speaking children

until Junior High School. The schools for the Spanish-speaking children were inferior in physical plant and equipment. Teachers looked upon assignments to such schools as less status than assignments to the Anglo-schools.

Became supervisor for Dona Ana County which at that time had 80% of the elementary school enrollment Spanish-speaking youngsters. Was appalled at the low educational opportunities of the Spanish-speaking children. Many of them were even taught by teachers who could not speak English although graduates of the state schools with proper state credentials. The children were taught by rote without any experiential background for the words they recited.

Special work within the school working with children as well as teachers accomplished changes in practices and procedures which showed by objective measurements that children learned more English and attended school more regularly. The New Mexico State Department of Education published the results of this study with the recommendations and descriptions of practice. It was possible a year after this to work in Chicago with a Polish -speaking group and thus extend and corroborate the observations in New Mexico.

Left Dona Ana County, New Mexico to Join the staff of the San Jose Experimental School at the University of New Mexico, Albuquerque. This position was combined with field work for the State Educational Department. As field worker and later as Director of the Curriculum Laboratory, it was my privilege to visit and work in schools through out the state. Comparisons in children's adjustment and educational opportunities in segregated and non-segregated schools were made continuously.

~~after~~ I left New Mexico and joined the staff of the Los Angeles County School Office as curriculum coordinator. Here the factor of segregation and the feeling of the majority group was much stronger than in New Mexico. The psychological results on both the Anglo-group and the Spanish-speaking group were correspondingly increased.

The past seven years in Los Angeles county have included special work at Loreda, Texas where the needs of Spanish-speaking children could be observed and a summer's work in a Segregated school in Los Angeles County to discover with greater specificity, the effects of such segregation on attitudes and educational accomplishment. The report of these findings is to be published by Los Angeles County School Office in February.

The past two years have been spent on leave of absence with the American Council on Education Intergroup Education Project. This assignment has sharpened observation of community effects of segregated schools and all practices based on assumption of inferiority of a part of the population.

Formal education includes degrees from the University of Chicago and doctorate work at Stanford University.

This is not too complete, you know about my summer teaching, etc - at summer school, teachers have described many, many teaching situations so I came to learn how they viewed their job as well as the difficulties under which they tried to teach -

M. M. H.

P.S. Excuse I must leave without time for re-typing -